

Customised medicine

Find out what the future of medicine holds. Tiny health monitors and tailored therapies could spell the end of illness <http://on.wsj.com/zlpum4>

Flipkart gone wild

Flipkart is all set to take on Junglee. It's gone into expansion overdrive with rumours of presence in Tier II & Tier III cities and towns

Bazaar

Sony BRAVIA KDL 55HX925

One of the best 55-inch smart TVs on the market

Sony BRAVIA KDL 55HX925 we get to see a much improved smart TV system. It's a 55-inch 3D LED backlit LCD TV having a native resolution of 1080p.

The stand that it comes with has to be screwed in to the base of the TV, so you will need some help in setting up the TV. Once screwed in, the sheer size of the TV commands respect. The glossy glass surface is quite reflective and when the TV is off, seems like a mirror. The Sony logo is placed in the centre at the base and it illuminates when TV is turned on. The glossy surface is a dust magnet.

There are a range of modes to play around with. By default in most of the modes, MotionFlow is activated. Motion Flow gives a sort of smoothness to the video by generating frames in between the actual frames, to give a more fluid video. We liked it in sports clips, as it succeeds in reducing judder due to fast movements. But while watching movies, we disabled Motion Flow as it tends to add an unreal element to the feel of the movie.

The TV sports the Sony XMB user interface, which is commonly seen on most Sony products such as the PS3 or Blu-ray players. Video quality was top notch. Colours were rendered very well and skin tones looked natural. In a dark room, you will notice that the blacks are quite deep, in fact if the dark black part is on the edges, it tends to merge with the bezel.

This is one of the few TVs that supports local LED dimming feature, which tends to dim backlit LEDs according to the scene when activated.

We also conducted the Lagom.nl tests. In the Contrast test, the blue, red and magenta bars tended to merge after block number 24. In the black level test, except for the first three blocks, each was easily identifiable. We did not notice any colour tinge which is great. Gradient banding was a smooth transition from black to white.

The 3D playback is decent so long as you have a high quality 3D Blu-ray video source. You can select the depth of 3D and also the type - side by side or top-bottom, even adjust the brightness of the glasses. You may want to keep your head steady, as the slightest bending on the left or right side, will cause the images to separate out. We did not like the 2D to 3D conversion at all. You cannot really see any depth there.

Among the numerous widgets supported, Facebook and Twitter are the most prominent. When you log in to Twitter for instance, the tweets can be viewed within the right hand side bar, with the TV content playing on the left hand side or you can go in the ticker mode. Facebook on the other hand takes you to the browser for logging in after which it can also be viewed on the side bar. If you are just going to read status updates, then the remote is fine. But if you want to update your status on either Facebook or Twitter, do not even think of using the remote control.

Bravia Internet Video connects you to a host of streaming video services including Dailymotion, Hungama, Star Player, among others. Sony has included the SET India



app which gives you access to 1000s of Sony India TV shows. You can browse through these exhaustive video streaming services if you get bored of watching regular TV. Also the integrated WiFi support allows you to wireless play content off your network drive.

Using Skype was a pleasure and its very easy to start a video call once you have connected the bundled camera to a USB port.

The remote control has a decent build quality and we really loved backlighting option. But having said that, it appears quite cluttered.

All this comes at a very hefty ₹2,59,900 which may seem very high. But then if you consider the features on offer - 3D support, connectivity to the net, a separate camera for Skype conversations, access to thousands of SET India TV shows, brilliant image quality, among others - we cannot complain much on pricing. Apart from the highly reflective screen, there aren't any glaring faults with the TV as such. Recommended for those looking at a lifestyle product with the performance chops.

Nimish Sawant

Specifications

Screen size: 55-inch; **Video Processor:** Xreality PRO engine; **3D Support:** Yes; **Audio output power:** 30W (10Wx3); **HDMI port:** 4; **USB port:** 2; **BRAVIA Sync:** Yes; **WiFi:** Integrated; **Backlight:** LED backlit LCD; **Native Resolution:** 1080p

Contact

Sony India
Phone: 18001037799
Website: www.sony.co.in
Price: ₹2,59,900

8.5/10

Features	9.0
Performance.....	8.5
Build Quality	9.0
Value for Money	7.0